

Adrian Erlikhman

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Firstness** – Software Engineering & ML Intern · [firstness.ai] · reporting directly to the founder 2026 – Present
- Refining how the platform connects into the research stack, and building demos that make it easier to understand.
- Kiddom** – Machine Learning Internship & Mentorship · K–12 EdTech 2026 – Present
- Designing ML and NLP approaches to teacher-facing problems in K–12 assessment with Kiddom’s Director of Data Science; built **Why Wrong**, which names the misconception behind each wrong answer on a class’s answer sheets (F1 0.87).
- Fjor Venture Capital** – Investment Intern · AI-focused venture fund 2024 – Present
- Ran diligence on 20+ early-stage AI startups and wrote 10+ full investment memos for partner-level decisions; led the screen of Y Combinator’s Summer 2025 batch with Managing Director Tatiana Janko.
- Alliance for SoCal Innovation** – Venture Outreach & Pipeline Intern 2024 – 2026
- Built the Alliance’s 250+ firm investor database in HubSpot and the schema it sorts on, and rewrote the founder intake form.

VENTURES & CIVIC TECHNOLOGY

- AIML-LI (AI/ML Literacy Initiative)** – Co-Founder & Lead · [aiml-initiative.org] 2023 – Present
- Co-wrote a free AI-literacy course, twelve 30-minute sessions any teacher can run on Chromebooks, taught in LACES AP Computer Science; LAUSD is taking it to its Chief Academic and Chief Information Officers toward a district elective.
 - Organizing the LA Student AI Summit & Hackathon for 200+ public-school students: keynotes from Google DeepMind, Microsoft, Google and Snap, backed by Snap, Jane Street, MongoDB, Confluent and Discovery Education.
 - Invited speaker, NCSS 2026:** aiEDU’s student panel on AI, National Consortium of STEM Schools, San Diego, Dec 2026.
- SafeJew** – Co-Founder · [safejew.org] · JFEDLA Teen Innovation Grant 2024 – Present
- Live map of 1,394 antisemitic incidents, 800 across Greater LA and 594 on 33 campuses, kept current by a scheduled GitHub Action and a hand-written LA gazetteer. Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase.

RESEARCH

- Self-Attribution Is Not Self-Recognition: A Peer Baseline for LLM Judges** *In submission, TACL*
- Co-first author, advised by Philo Juang (Google DeepMind). Five frontier LLM judges over 190 responses, each scored against a peer baseline: Claude names its own writing 86.8% against 53.9% for its peers ($p = 1.6 \times 10^{-4}$), and an 18-feature stylometric classifier (86.3%) beats every judge.
- Do LLM Fingerprints Survive Outside English?** *Under review, IEEE BigData 2026 HS Symposium*
- Co-first author. 840 essays from five models in seven languages: attribution holds at 59–72% against 20% chance, with no detected drop for low-resource languages, and survives Google Translate. [abstract] [poster] [code]
- Proximity, Not Transmission:**
- What the Patent Record Can and Cannot Show About NLP and Surveillance** *Submitting, AI for Peace @ NeurIPS 2026*
- Co-first author, with Michael Tarekgn. Linked 127,851 ACL Anthology papers to the 9,048 USPTO patents citing them; name-blind coding finds 0.46% surveillance, no different from science-citing patents of the same era (OR 1.03, CI 0.38–2.78). [abstract] [code]
- How Robust Are the Legatum Prosperity Index Rankings?** *Accepted with revisions, Journal of High School Science*
- Co-first author, with Ryan Erlikhman. Derived rank leverage, $c^2(1 - \rho^2)$, which tracks Sobol’ total effects (Spearman 0.91–0.99); the ranking holds globally but not mid-table, where the median 90% rank interval spans 36 places. [pdf]

COMPETITIONS

- Y Combinator Startup School**, sub-5%, \$30,000+ in credits [about] · **Finalist (top 8), Citadel High School Terminal** [about]
- 1st place, VISION HACK: South LA** (Council District 9 Champion, U18). Ledger: led the build across the vision pipeline, rule engine and frontend, and wrote the two-pass vision pipeline, the dashboard and renewal calendar, and the static fallback. [live]
- 1st place, Decode the Ocean Hackathon** (Lovable × UN). eDNAtlas: live coastal health scores from environmental DNA. [live]
- 3rd place internationally, Code for Transportation** (Young Coders’ Sphere). Safe Routes to School: A* over 431,599 crime-scored LA blocks, entirely in the browser; the bus cuts a student’s modeled exposure by up to 80%. [live]

EDUCATION

- Los Angeles Center for Enriched Studies (LACES)** – Class of 2027 · LAUSD magnet school Los Angeles, CA
- GPA 5.2 weighted, 4.0 unweighted · SAT 1520 · 2× AP Scholar with Distinction · 17 APs
 - Dual enrollment: Linear Algebra (MATH 270) · Programming in Python (CS 119) · Python for Data Science and ML (CS 121, planned)

LEADERSHIP & ATHLETICS

- Épée fencing:** USA Fencing A26; Team USA, 2026 Cadet Pan American Championships (6th); U.S. No. 49 Junior and No. 78 Senior, peak No. 17 Cadet; 3× All-American First Team; in active recruitment with MIT.
- President**, Jewish Student Union (50+ members) · **Co-Founder & President**, STEMsters (30+ volunteers in 4 elementary schools)

SKILLS

- Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, SQL, LaTeX · PyTorch, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, pandas, NumPy · Next.js, React, Supabase · LLM evaluation, stylometry, Monte Carlo and Sobol’ sensitivity analysis · English, Russian (fluent), Spanish